

Team Number: _____

Time: _____

Rank: _____



SMALL BUSINESS MANAGEMENT TEAM

(510)

**NATIONAL 2025
PRELIMS**

INITIAL CASE STUDY TOPIC

Innovation Retail, a well-established chain of brick-and-mortar retail stores, is grappling with declining sales due to the surge in e-commerce. The stores, located in a city of 550,000 people, employ eight full-time employees at each of their four locations located in different parts of the city. The hours of operation at each store are Monday – Friday from 9:00 a.m. – 5:30 p.m., Saturday from 9:00 a.m. – 2:00 p.m., and closed on Sunday.

Over the past two years, in-store sales have dropped significantly: by 27% at store 1, 24% at store 2, and 19% at store 3. At the fourth store's location, there was a slight increase in sales of 15%. CEO Matthew Lawrence has decided to embark on a digital transformation project to integrate online and offline shopping experiences, tasking project manager Monroe Lewis and his team with leading this initiative. However, due to the continued decrease in sales and multiple attempts to generate additional income, discussions are now taking place about potentially cutting employees at each location. Even though total sales decreased at three stores, each full-time salesperson was paid a 20% commission on every purchase plus a bonus.

Internal Challenges

- Employee morale
- Employee digital skills gap
- Balancing resources between physical stores and developing the digital platform
- Employee costs

External Challenges

- Technology adoption
- E-commerce competition
- Economic factors
- Changing consumer behavior

As a team, you will develop a plan with different strategies for Monroe Lewis and his team to employ to help Innovation Retail be more profitable. While developing your plan, consider the following questions:

- How can Innovation Retail use its physical stores to make online shopping better and attract more customers?
- What online marketing methods can help bring more people to both the website and the physical stores?
- What new technology is needed to connect online and in-store shopping smoothly?
- How can Innovation Retail make customers more loyal and keep them coming back?
- What ways can Innovation Retail save money without hurting employee morale or customer service?

MODIFICATION

Just as Innovation Retail begins to implement its new strategies, the economy takes an unexpected downturn, significantly affecting consumer spending. Simultaneously, the company faces a legal challenge as a group of customers files a class-action lawsuit related to the data breach, alleging negligence in protecting their personal information. This combination of economic and legal pressures adds further strain to the company's resources and strategic plans.

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